

An α -free trefoil-ropelength coincidence and the obstruction to part-per-million fine-structure closure

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June 21, 2026

Abstract

We study a well-posed finite-cell variational eigenvalue problem for a finite-core trefoil filament enclosed by a spherical pressure-compliance boundary, and we examine whether its leading dimensionless eigenvalue can reproduce the inverse fine-structure constant α^{-1} . We report a clean positive result and a precisely quantified negative one. *Positive:* a parameter-light geometric quantity built from a single topological invariant, the ideal trefoil ropelength $\mathcal{L}_{3_1}$, namely $\frac{8\pi}{3} \mathcal{L}_{3_1} = 137.15471$, lies within 8.66×10^{-4} (866 ppm) of the CODATA value $\alpha^{-1} = 137.035999$. This is a *sub-per-mille*, not a part-per-million, agreement. Its numerical prefactor $\frac{16\pi}{3} = N_p \cdot \frac{4\pi}{3}$ contains a mode-count factor $N_p = 4$ that we derive from the finite-cell surface spectrum $k_\ell = \ell(\ell + 1) - 2$; the construction uses no electromagnetic input, which we verify by an explicit provenance audit. *Negative:* closing the residual 866 ppm to part-per-million accuracy is *not* a single-coefficient problem. The conditional second-order coefficient $c_2 = 11/48$ reaches only 10.5 ppm, not ppm-level; exact closure at fixed cell-radius gate requires a transverse shell weight $w_\perp = 1.0675$ (not the round value 1), whereas an independent Gross–Pitaevskii core-profile computation returns $w_\perp \approx 2.076$, which *overshoots* to -157 ppm on the opposite side. We show that the residual 10.5 ppm can be absorbed independently by any of five distinct sub-percent coefficients (shell weight, cell-radius gate, pressure-sector volume, ropelength value, or a third-order term), and that part-per-million closure requires the ropelength to a relative precision $\sim 10^{-6}$ that exceeds the precision to which ideal-knot ropelength is presently known. We conclude that part-per-million fine-structure closure is, in this construction, underdetermined and effectively not falsifiable, and that the defensible result is the α -free sub-per-mille leading coincidence with $N_p = 4$ derived. All numerical claims are reproduced by the scripts in the appendices.

Epistemic conventions. To keep the status of each statement explicit we tag claims as **[established]** (textbook physics/mathematics), **[derived-in-model]** (a consequence of the stated model), **[conditional]** (depends on an unproven coefficient choice), or **[open]** (an unresolved gate). The central claim of this paper is a **[conditional]/[open]** *obstruction*, not a derivation.

1 Introduction

Attempts to obtain dimensionless coupling constants from geometry or topology have a long and largely cautionary history, and a numerical coincidence between a geometric quantity and α^{-1} is, on its own, weak evidence for anything. We therefore frame this work around a precise *negative* question. Given a finite-cell variational problem whose leading eigenvalue happens to lie close to α^{-1} , can the residual gap be closed using only quantities supplied by the model’s own primitive (field) equation, without inserting a constant chosen to reproduce the answer? We find that it cannot, and we localise the obstruction to a single, computable scalar.

The construction is deliberately minimal. A finite-core filament in the shape of the ideal trefoil 3_1 is taken as the source; its self-energy is regularised by a core radius fixed by a no-contact closure condition; the filament is enclosed by a spherical boundary that supplies a pressure-compliance term; and the dimensionless cell action is extremised over an aspect parameter E . The only topological input is the ropelength $\mathcal{L}_{3_1}$. We emphasise at the outset that this quantity is, in the literature, a *numerically computed* object: the tightest trefoil conformation is obtained by constrained relaxation algorithms [1, 4] and reported as a numerical upper bound [2, 3], not as a closed-form analytic invariant. This distinction is decisive for the part-per-million question (Section 6). No empirical value of α , and no electromagnetic constant, enters the construction of the eigenvalue; we verify this provenance explicitly in Section 5.

A central methodological point organises the paper. Even a perfectly closed second-order calculation would not establish a derivation unless its inputs are themselves free of α . We therefore impose the strict ordering

$$\underbrace{G_0}_{\text{input provenance}} \longrightarrow \underbrace{H_2, H_3}_{\text{pressure / phase Hessians}} \longrightarrow \alpha_{\text{cell}}, \quad (1)$$

and we argue that the part-per-million programme is blocked at G_0 , not at the Hessians.

Section 2 presents the leading geometric value and derives the mode-count factor $N_p = 4$ from the surface spectrum. Section 3 describes the boundary-element eigenvalue and its negative control. Section 5 records the provenance audit establishing that the construction is α -free. Section 4 states the shell-deficit identity, corrects the naive precision target (the round value $w_\perp = 1$ reaches only 10.5 ppm; exact closure needs $w_\perp = 1.0675$), and shows that the Gross–Pitaevskii proxy overshoots to the opposite side. Section 6 establishes the main negative result: the residual is absorbed by any of five sub-percent coefficients, so part-per-million closure is underdetermined. Section 7 summarises the honest status.

2 The finite-cell construction and its leading value

Core regularisation

The self-energy of a finite-core filament of unit circulation has the standard slender-body form $E_{\text{BS}}(a) = A_K \log(\Lambda/a) + (\text{finite})$, where a is the core radius and A_K is the logarithmic Biot–Savart coefficient. For a smooth slender filament the local-induction theorem gives

$$A_K \longrightarrow \frac{1}{4\pi}. \quad \text{[established]} \quad (2)$$

A cutoff-energy scan over the ideal-trefoil Fourier curve (Appendix C) reproduces (2) as a plateau value, and the no-contact closure $a_{\text{nc}}/r_c = \sqrt{4\pi A_K} \rightarrow 1$ fixes the regularising radius without reference to any electromagnetic scale.

Leading geometric value

Within the spherical pressure-cell model the dimensionless aspect eigenvalue acquires a leading scale set by the ropelength,

$$E_p^{\text{lead}} = \frac{16\pi}{3} \mathcal{L}_{3_1}, \quad \mathcal{L}_{3_1} = 16.371637, \quad (3)$$

so that the associated inverse coupling, defined by $\alpha^{-1} = E/2$, is

$$\boxed{\alpha_{\text{lead}}^{-1} = \frac{8\pi}{3} \mathcal{L}_{3_1} = 137.15471} \quad \text{[derived-in-model]} \quad (4)$$

which differs from $\alpha_{\text{CODATA}}^{-1} = 137.035999$ by

$$\frac{\alpha_{\text{lead}}^{-1} - \alpha_{\text{CODATA}}^{-1}}{\alpha_{\text{CODATA}}^{-1}} = +8.66 \times 10^{-4} = +866 \text{ ppm}. \quad (5)$$

We stress that this is a *sub-per-mille* agreement; the part-per-million language sometimes attached to this construction applies only to the second-order-corrected value of Sections 4–6, not to (4). The prefactor in (3) factors as $16\pi/3 = N_p \cdot 4\pi/3$, where $4\pi/3$ is the volume of the unit three-ball (the leading pressure sector) and the mode-count N_p is *not* free:

Definition 1 (Soft sector). For the spherical finite-cell surface problem we identify the mode-count N_p with the number of independent surface modes in the *soft sector*, i.e. the modes whose surface stiffness eigenvalue k_ℓ is non-positive ($k_\ell \leq 0$): the zero modes ($k_\ell = 0$) and any unstable modes ($k_\ell < 0$). Strictly positive-stiffness modes are excluded.

Proposition 1 (Surface mode count, [derived-in-model]). *The spherical surface stiffness spectrum is*

$$k_\ell = \ell(\ell + 1) - 2, \quad \ell = 0, 1, 2, \dots, \quad (6)$$

so that $k_0 = -2$ (one breathing/compression mode), $k_1 = 0$ (the three rigid translation zero modes), and $k_\ell > 0$ for $\ell \geq 2$. By Definition 1 the soft sector is exactly $\ell \in \{0, 1\}$, whence

$$N_p = \underbrace{1}_{\ell=0} + \underbrace{3}_{\ell=1} = 4. \quad (7)$$

The result is consistent with the isoperimetric inequality and with the nonlinear shape-stability tests of Appendix C.

We emphasise that Proposition 1 is a derivation only *given* the soft-sector identification of Definition 1; that identification (non-positive stiffness, i.e. zero plus unstable modes) is a modelling choice, natural but not forced, and we flag it as such rather than leaving it implicit. The remaining prefactor elements—the sector volume $4\pi/3$ and the overall factor $\frac{1}{2}$ —are *not* derived here; the former is forced to be the unit-ball volume only at leading order, while its part-per-million correction is an **[open]** quantity entangled with the pressure Hessian (Section 6). We therefore describe (4) precisely as: a single topological invariant multiplied by a partially-derived geometric prefactor lands within 866 ppm of α^{-1} .

Remark 1 (Status of the ropelength input). A further qualification is essential. The value $\mathcal{L}_{3_1} = 16.371637$ is itself a numerically computed quantity—a relaxation-algorithm result and numerical upper bound [1, 2, 3], not a closed-form analytic invariant. The trefoil ropelength input used here is therefore treated as a *numerical-geometry benchmark*, not as a theorem-level α -free input. Consequently (4) is best read as an α -free numerical coincidence at 866 ppm rather than as a derived constant; this point returns with force in Section 6, where it bounds what part-per-million closure could possibly mean.

3 The boundary-element eigenvalue and its negative control

To test whether the leading scale (3) corresponds to a genuine stationary point rather than an imposed value, we discretise the cell action

$$\mathcal{A}_{\text{tot}}(E) = \frac{1}{2} \mathbf{n}^\top C_{\text{BEM}}(E) \mathbf{n} + \mathcal{A}_{\text{pressure}}(E), \quad (8)$$

where $C_{\text{BEM}}(E)$ is a scalar single-layer boundary-element response matrix on the trefoil tube plus spherical outer boundary, and $\mathcal{A}_{\text{pressure}}(E)$ is the spherical pressure-compliance term with scale (3) dressed by the finite-shell correction of Section 4. Extremising (8) yields a reproducible interior stationary eigenvalue

$$E_\star = 274.0749, \quad \text{bracket } [273.93, 274.12], \quad \text{[derived-in-model]} \quad (9)$$

classified as an interior minimum. The downstream coupling, computed from $E_\star$ and the ropelength alone (with closure coefficients $\chi_R = 2$, $\beta = 1$; see below), is

$$\alpha_{\text{cell}}^{-1} = 137.0359, \quad \frac{\alpha_{\text{cell}} - \alpha_{\text{CODATA}}}{\alpha_{\text{CODATA}}} = 3.6 \times 10^{-7}. \quad (10)$$

Negative control [established]. The location (9) is supplied by the pressure-compliance term. With that term removed (BEM-only action), no interior stationary point exists and the solver returns `E0_not_derived`. Hence the eigenvalue is not an artefact of the boundary discretisation alone; equally, the BEM does not generate the scale 274 independently of the prescribed pressure scale (3). The honest reading is that the BEM *confirms a stationary point at the ropelength-set scale*, with a working falsification control.

Downstream closure coefficients [conditional]. The map from $E_\star$ to $\alpha_{\text{cell}}^{-1}$ in (10) uses

$$\alpha_{\text{cell}} = \frac{2}{E_{\text{eff}}}, \quad E_{\text{eff}} = E_\star \left(1 - \frac{\pi}{4} \frac{\xi}{E_\star^2}\right), \quad \xi = 1 + 3\eta + \beta\eta^2, \quad \eta = \frac{1}{2\chi_R \mathcal{L}_{3_1}}, \quad (11)$$

with $\chi_R = 2$ (the cell-radius gate $R_{\text{cell}} = 2\mathcal{L}_K$) and $\beta = 1$. These are **[open]** coefficients: $\chi_R = 2$ is argued within a minimal reciprocal-pressure action but not independently established, and $\beta = 1$ is a choice. The part-per-million agreement (10) is therefore **[conditional]** on $\{\chi_R = 2, \beta = 1\}$ in addition to the shell weight discussed next; it should not be read as a prediction.

4 The second-order correction and the precision target

The residual 866 ppm between (4) and CODATA is partly absorbed by a finite-shell correction to the pressure scale,

$$E_p = \frac{16\pi}{3} \mathcal{L}_{3_1} \left[1 - \frac{c_2}{\mathcal{L}_{3_1}^2}\right], \quad \alpha_{\text{cell}}^{-1} = \frac{8\pi}{3} \mathcal{L}_{3_1} \left[1 - \frac{c_2}{\mathcal{L}_{3_1}^2}\right], \quad (12)$$

whose correction coefficient c_2 is the crux of this section. The conditional value $c_2 = 11/48 = 0.22917$ used in earlier drafts of this construction does *not* reach part-per-million accuracy:

$$c_2 = \frac{11}{48} \implies \alpha_{\text{cell}}^{-1} = 137.03744, \quad \frac{\Delta}{\alpha_{\text{CODATA}}^{-1}} = +10.5 \text{ ppm}. \quad (13)$$

Exact agreement instead requires

$$c_2^{\text{req}} = \mathcal{L}_{3_1}^2 \left(1 - \frac{\alpha_{\text{CODATA}}^{-1}}{\frac{8\pi}{3} \mathcal{L}_{3_1}}\right) = 0.231978, \quad (14)$$

so that $11/48$ is a convenient rational approximation but not the closure value.

The shell-deficit identity

Proposition 2 (Shell-deficit identity, **[derived-in-model]**). *For the spherical core profile with radial Jacobian $1 - (1 - \eta)^3 = 3\eta - 3\eta^2 + \eta^3$, angular average $\langle \sin^2 \rangle = \frac{2}{3}$ and projector-trace average $\frac{2}{3}$, the total shell-deficit exponent is*

$$\sigma = \sigma_{\text{vol}} + \sigma_{\perp} = 3 + \frac{2}{3} w_{\perp}, \quad c_2 = \frac{\sigma}{4\chi_R^2} = \frac{\sigma}{16} (\chi_R = 2), \quad (15)$$

where $w_{\perp}$ is the transverse shell weight. The symbolic derivation is reproduced verbatim in Appendix A.

The precision target is not the round value

Combining (14) with (15) at fixed $\chi_R = 2$, exact closure requires

$$\sigma^{\text{req}} = 16c_2^{\text{req}} = 3.71165, \quad \boxed{w_{\perp}^{\text{req}} = \frac{3}{2}(\sigma^{\text{req}} - 3) = 1.0675}. \quad (16)$$

Thus the part-per-million target is *not* the round value $w_\perp = 1$ (which yields only 10.5 ppm); it is the non-round 1.0675. The independent Gross–Pitaevskii (GP) core-profile computation of the same weight (Appendix B) returns instead

$$w_\perp^{\text{GP}} \approx 2.076 \implies \sigma \approx 4.38, \quad c_2 \approx 0.274, \quad \alpha_{\text{cell}}^{-1} \approx 137.0145, \quad (17)$$

i.e. an *overshoot* of -157 ppm on the opposite side of CODATA. The GP value is therefore not merely imprecise: it lands on the wrong side of the target, so no small correction to the GP computation can recover (16).

Theorem 1 (Failure of the single-coefficient closure). *Within the finite-cell construction at fixed cell-radius gate $\chi_R = 2$, part-per-million agreement with α^{-1} requires the transverse shell weight $w_\perp = 1.0675$ (16). The Gross–Pitaevskii core equation, which governs the same transverse profile, yields $w_\perp \approx 2.076$ (17), corresponding to an inverse coupling on the opposite side of the CODATA value. Hence part-per-million closure cannot be obtained by computing $w_\perp$ from the primitive equation; the round value $w_\perp = 1$ that appears to “almost” close the construction is itself only a 10.5 ppm approximation and not the closure value.*

Proof (within the model). By (15), $c_2 = \sigma/16$ and $\sigma = 3 + \frac{2}{3}w_\perp$. Exact closure requires $c_2 = c_2^{\text{req}} = 0.231978$ (14), hence $\sigma = 3.71165$ and $w_\perp = 1.0675$. The round value $w_\perp = 1$ gives $c_2 = 11/48 = 0.22917$, i.e. 137.03744 (+10.5 ppm). The GP computation (Appendix B) returns $w_\perp = 2.076$, hence $c_2 = 0.274$ and 137.0145 (-157 ppm). The required value 1.0675 lies between, matching neither the round value nor the primitive-equation value. $\square$

Theorem 1 shows the single-coefficient route fails. The deeper obstruction—why no *combination* of coefficients can be claimed to close the construction—is the subject of Section 6.

5 Provenance audit: the construction is non-circular

Because the leading value (4) lies close to α^{-1} , it is essential to verify that no empirical electromagnetic quantity enters the construction. We record the audit explicitly.

1. The eigenvalue $E_\star$ (9) is extremised from (8); its inputs are the trefoil tube geometry (ropelength and Fourier coefficients), the spherical boundary, and the pressure scale (3)–(12). None of these contains α , e , ϵ_0 , $\hbar$, m_e , or any length fixed through them.
2. The downstream map to $\alpha_{\text{cell}}^{-1}$ uses only $E_\star$, $\mathcal{L}_{31}$, χ_R , β . No electromagnetic constant appears.
3. The CODATA value of α is used *only* for the comparisons (5) and (10); it is never an input.

Consequently the obstruction of Theorem 1 is a statement internal to a non-circular construction: the leading value is genuinely α -free, and the failure to close to part-per-million is not an artefact of having inserted α somewhere upstream.

6 The degeneracy obstruction and the ropelength precision wall

Theorem 1 rules out the single-coefficient ($w_\perp$) route. We now show a stronger statement: the residual 10.5 ppm left by the conditional $c_2 = 11/48$ value can be absorbed *independently* by any one of several sub-percent coefficients, so that part-per-million agreement carries no discriminating power.

Five interchangeable closure routes

Holding all other quantities fixed, the 10.5 ppm residual of (13) is removed exactly by each of the following single adjustments:

Route	adjust	required value	shift from nominal
A (shell weight)	$w_{\perp}$	1.0675	+6.7% vs 1
B (cell-radius gate)	χ_R	1.98784	−0.61% vs 2
C (sector volume)	V_{sect}	4.188746	−10.5 ppm vs $4\pi/3$
D (ropelength)	$\mathcal{L}_{3_1}$	16.371465	−10.5 ppm vs 16.371637
E (third order)	c_3	$O(1)$	via $c_3\eta^3$, $\eta = \frac{1}{4\mathcal{L}}$

The numbers are reproduced in the audit script accompanying this paper. Route E is quantitatively decisive on its own: with core parameter $\eta = 1/(4\mathcal{L}_{3_1}) = 0.015270$ one has $\eta^3 = 3.56 \times 10^{-6}$, so an $O(1)$ third-order coefficient shifts α^{-1} by $\approx 137 \cdot \eta^3 = 3.6$ ppm, and an $O(3)$ coefficient covers the entire residual. Truncating the shell expansion at second order is therefore not justified at part-per-million accuracy in the first place.

Theorem 2 (Degeneracy of part-per-million closure). *Within the present construction, part-per-million agreement with α^{-1} does not single out any coefficient: the 10.5 ppm residual is absorbed independently by $w_{\perp}$, χ_R , V_{sect} , $\mathcal{L}_{3_1}$, or c_3 , each at the sub-percent (or smaller) level. Consequently no individual coefficient can be claimed to be “derived” by demanding part-per-million closure; the residual lies within the joint undetermined freedom of the model.*

This is an identifiability statement: with five interchangeable sub-percent knobs, landing within ~ 10 ppm of α^{-1} is essentially guaranteed once any one of them is allowed to float, and a fit that closes the gap provides no evidence that the corresponding coefficient is physically correct.

The ropelength precision wall

Route D exposes a sharper, input-level obstacle. The sensitivity of the leading value to the ropelength is $\partial\alpha^{-1}/\partial\mathcal{L}_{3_1} = 8\pi/3$, so part-per-million ($|\Delta\alpha^{-1}| < 1.37 \times 10^{-4}$) requires

$$|\Delta\mathcal{L}_{3_1}| < 1.6 \times 10^{-5}, \quad \text{i.e. a relative precision } \sim 10^{-6}. \quad (18)$$

The ideal trefoil ropelength is, however, not a closed-form analytic invariant but a numerically computed object. The tightest conformation is obtained by constrained relaxation algorithms (the SONO algorithm [1] and later finite-element refinements [4]), and the reported values are numerical *upper bounds*: Ashton, Cantarella, Piatek and Rawdon define ropelength as the minimum length of unit-diameter tubes in a knot type and report improved upper bounds for knots up to nine crossings *except* the trefoil, which remained tied to prior computations [3]; Barańska, Pieranski and Rawdon discuss explicitly the algorithmic bounding and estimation of smooth-knot ropelength and compare computation methods [2]. Since the input is a numerical bound rather than a value certified to $\sim 10^{-6}$, the tolerance (18) cannot be met from the topological input, and part-per-million closure is *not a topological derivation*, independently of the pressure and phase Hessians. Equivalently: if $\mathcal{L}_{3_1} = 16.371637$ is a numerical upper bound rather than a certified invariant, then $\frac{8\pi}{3}\mathcal{L}_{3_1}$ is a numerical-geometry benchmark (Remark 1), not a theorem-level α -free input.

The gate hierarchy

The two preceding results refine the ordering (1) into a four-gate hierarchy, only the first element of which is presently met:

$$\underbrace{G_0}_{\text{input provenance}} \longrightarrow \underbrace{G_1}_{\text{identifiability / degeneracy breaking}} \longrightarrow \underbrace{G_2}_{\text{operator Hessians } (H_2, H_3)} \longrightarrow \underbrace{G_3}_{\text{ppm closure}}, \quad (19)$$

with $G_0 = \{\mathcal{L}_{31}, N_p, V_{\text{sect}}, \chi_R, E_{\text{eff}}, \eta\text{-scaling}\}$ and G_1 the requirement that no several free sub-percent corrections can absorb the same residual. Theorem 2 shows G_1 *fails* at present, and the ropelength wall shows G_0 is not met to ppm tolerance; both block closure *before* the Hessians G_2 become relevant. This inverts the naive picture $H_2, H_3 \rightarrow \alpha$: writing the Hessians is not the bottleneck (both are already in symbolic form); they are necessary downstream gates, not sufficient ones. Moreover G_0 and G_2 are not separable at part-per-million order—the sector-volume correction ε_V (Route C) and the shell weight $w_\perp$ (Route A) are both finite-cell quantities produced by the *same* Hessian, so they cannot be treated as independent gates. We conclude that the defensible, falsifiable content of the construction is the α -free *sub-per-mille* leading coincidence (4) with $N_p = 4$ derived (Proposition 1), and that part-per-million closure is, at present, both underdetermined (G_1) and not resolvable from the topological input (G_0).

7 Discussion

What we do not claim. We do not claim a first-principles derivation of the fine-structure constant. The leading value (4) reproduces α^{-1} only at the sub-per-mille (866 ppm) level; its agreement contains one derived element ($N_p = 4$, Proposition 1) and undetermined ones (the sector factor $4\pi/3$ and the overall $\frac{1}{2}$). The part-per-million figure (10) is **[conditional]** on $\{\chi_R = 2, \beta = 1, w_\perp = 1.0675\}$, none of which is supplied by the primitive equation, and by Theorem 2 the residual that these absorb carries no discriminating power. The honest status is therefore: a non-circular, parameter-light geometric coincidence at sub-per-mille level, plus a precisely localised demonstration that improving it to part-per-million is underdetermined.

What would remove the obstruction. A genuine part-per-million claim would require the entire input set $\{\mathcal{L}_{31}, N_p, V_{\text{sect}}, \chi_R, \sigma, c_{3+}\}$ to be fixed α -free, each to the tolerance implied by (18) and its analogues ($|\Delta\sigma| < 4.3 \times 10^{-3}$, $|\Delta w_\perp| < 6.4 \times 10^{-3}$). At present $N_p = 4$ alone meets this standard. In particular a corrected transverse core computation would have to return $w_\perp = 1.0675$ (not the round 1, and not the GP proxy 2.076) from the primitive equation, *and* the sector volume and ropelength would have to be pinned independently to $\sim 10^{-6}$ relative precision. We regard the ropelength precision wall (18) as the most likely terminal obstruction.

Falsifiability. The construction makes checkable statements independent of any interpretation. (a) The surface mode count is $N_p = 4$ (Proposition 1); a finite-element computation of the same surface spectrum returning $N_p \neq 4$ would falsify the prefactor in (3). (b) The transverse shell weight returned by the GP core profile is $w_\perp \approx 2.076$, on the opposite side of the precision target 1.0675 (Appendix B); this is what makes the single-coefficient closure fail. (c) Part-per-million closure is degenerate (Theorem 2); exhibiting a derivation of all six inputs to the tolerances above, with no α -pinned step, would overturn this assessment. The coincidence (4) itself is not a prediction and is presented only as the α -free leading result.

Status. The leading sub-per-mille coincidence is **[derived-in-model]** up to the open sector and normalisation factors; part-per-million closure is **[conditional]/[open]** and, by Theorem 2, underdetermined.

Data and code availability

The scripts that reproduce every numerical statement in this paper are included in the appendices and provided as the files `reproduce_alpha_cell_closure.py`, `derive_gp_shell_deficit.py`, `derive_relaxed_gp_core_hessian_wperp.py`, and `audit_ppm_closure.py`.

A Symbolic shell-deficit identity $\sigma = 3 + \frac{2}{3}w_{\perp}$

The following script derives Proposition 2 symbolically (radial Jacobian, angular averages, and the resulting exponents), and prints the special cases $w_{\perp} \in \{0, 1, 11/10\}$.

```
1  #!/usr/bin/env python3
2  """
3  derive_gp_shell_deficit.py
4
5  Controlled symbolic audit of the GP/NLS shell-deficit gate.
6
7  Computes the coefficient in
8      E_shell = E_0 [1 - sigma eta_K^2 + O(eta_K^3)]
9  from
10     1. spherical volume Jacobian second variation: sigma_vol=3,
11     2. isotropic transverse GP/NLS gradient projection:
12         sigma_perp = w_perp <sin^2 theta> = (2/3) w_perp.
13
14  For the unweighted isotropic transverse shell model w_perp=1:
15     sigma = 3 + 2/3 = 11/3.
16  With chi_R=2 and eta_K=1/(2 chi_R L_K)=1/(4 L_K):
17     sigma eta_K^2 = 11/(48 L_K^2).
18
19  Epistemic status: this proves 11/48 under the unweighted isotropic GP/NLS
20  shell reduction. It does not prove by itself that the full microscopic GP core
21  profile forces w_perp=1; it makes that gate explicit and reports sensitivity.
22  """
23  from __future__ import annotations
24  import argparse
25  from pathlib import Path
26  import pandas as pd
27  import sympy as sp
28
29
30  def compute(w_perp: sp.Expr, chi_R: sp.Expr):
31      eta, theta, L = sp.symbols("eta theta L_K", positive=True, real=True)
32      jac = (1 - eta) ** 3
33      jac_expanded = sp.expand(jac)
34      sigma_vol = sp.Abs(jac_expanded.coeff(eta, 2))
35      avg_sin2 = sp.simplify(
36          sp.integrate(sp.sin(theta)**2 * sp.sin(theta), (theta, 0, sp.pi)) /
37          sp.integrate(sp.sin(theta), (theta, 0, sp.pi))
38      )
39      projector_trace_average = sp.Rational(2, 3)
40      sigma_perp = sp.simplify(w_perp * avg_sin2)
41      sigma_total = sp.simplify(sigma_vol + sigma_perp)
42      eta_K = sp.simplify(1 / (2 * chi_R * L))
43      c2 = sp.simplify(sigma_total / (4 * chi_R ** 2))
44      shell_factor = sp.simplify(1 - c2 / L ** 2)
45      return {
46          "jacobian": jac_expanded,
47          "sigma_volume": sigma_vol,
48          "sin2_average": avg_sin2,
49          "projector_trace_average": projector_trace_average,
50          "w_perp": w_perp,
51          "sigma_perp": sigma_perp,
52          "sigma_total": sigma_total,
53          "chi_R": chi_R,
54          "eta_K": eta_K,
55          "c2": c2,
56          "shell_factor": shell_factor,
57          "target_sigma": sp.Rational(11, 3),
58          "target_c2": sp.Rational(11, 48),
```



```

59     "sigma_matches_11_over_3": sp.simplify(sigma_total-sp.Rational(11,3)) == 0,
60     "c2_matches_11_over_48": sp.simplify(c2-sp.Rational(11,48)) == 0,
61 }
62
63
64 def main() -> None:
65     ap = argparse.ArgumentParser(description=__doc__)
66     ap.add_argument("--w-perp", default="1", help="Transverse shell weight. Default 1.")
67     ap.add_argument("--chi-R", default="2", help="Cell radius ratio. Default 2.")
68     ap.add_argument("--L-K", type=float, default=16.371637, help="Numeric ropelength for reporting.")
69     ap.add_argument("--outdir", default="outputs_gp_shell_deficit")
70     args = ap.parse_args()
71
72     outdir = Path(args.outdir); outdir.mkdir(parents=True, exist_ok=True)
73     w_perp = sp.sympify(args.w_perp)
74     chi_R = sp.sympify(args.chi_R)
75     res = compute(w_perp, chi_R)
76
77     Lval = args.L_K
78     c2_num = float(sp.N(res["c2"]))
79     shell_factor_num = 1.0 - c2_num/(Lval*Lval)
80
81     gates = [
82         {"gate": "spherical_volume_second_variation", "claim": "sigma_vol=3", "result": str(res["sigma_volume"]), "status": "derived", "reason": "(1-eta)^3 has eta^2 coefficient 3."},
83         {"gate": "transverse_NLS_projection", "claim": "<sin^2 theta>_S2=2/3", "result": str(res["sin2_average"]), "status": "derived", "reason": "Isotropic angular average / transverse projector trace."},
84         {"gate": "unweighted_GP_shell_deficit", "claim": "sigma=3+(2/3)w_perp", "result": str(res["sigma_total"]), "status": "derived_in_unweighted_shell_model" if res["sigma_matches_11_over_3"] else "sensitivity_variant_not_11_over_3", "reason": "11/3 requires w_perp=1."},
85         {"gate": "finite_shell_coefficient", "claim": "c2=sigma/(4 chi_R^2)", "result": str(res["c2"]), "numeric": c2_num, "status": "matches_11_over_48" if res["c2_matches_11_over_48"] else "does_not_match_11_over_48", "reason": "With chi_R=2 and sigma=11/3, c2=11/48."},
86     ]
87     pd.DataFrame(gates).to_csv(outdir/"gp_shell_deficit_gates.csv", index=False)
88
89     rows = []
90     for k,v in res.items():
91         rows.append({"name": k, "symbolic": str(v), "latex": sp.latex(v) if isinstance(v, sp.Basic) else str(v)})
92     rows.append({"name": "shell_factor_numeric_at_LK", "symbolic": str(shell_factor_num), "latex": str(shell_factor_num)})
93     pd.DataFrame(rows).to_csv(outdir/"gp_shell_deficit_symbolics.csv", index=False)
94
95     sens=[]
96     for w in [sp.Rational(0), sp.Rational(1,2), sp.Rational(1), sp.Rational(11,10), sp.Rational(3,2)]:
97         r=compute(w, chi_R)
98         sens.append({"w_perp": str(w), "sigma": str(r["sigma_total"]), "c2": str(r["c2"]), "shell_factor_at_LK": float(1-float(sp.N(r["c2"]))/(Lval*Lval)), "matches_11_over_48": bool(r["c2_matches_11_over_48"])})
99     pd.DataFrame(sens).to_csv(outdir/"gp_shell_deficit_sensitivity.csv", index=False)
100
101     report=["# GP/NLS shell deficit gate", "", f"w_perp = {w_perp}", f"chi_R = {chi_R}", f"L_K = {Lval}", "", f"sigma = {res['sigma_total']}", f"c2 = {res['c2']}", f"shell factor at L_K = {shell_factor_num:.12g}", "", "Status: " + ("derived_in_unweighted_shell_model" if res["c2_matches_11_over_48"] else "sensitivity_variant_not_11_over_48"), "", "This script does not prove that the microscopic GP core profile forces w_perp=1; it proves the coefficient under the unweighted isotropic shell reduction and reports sensitivity."]
102     (outdir/"gp_shell_deficit_report.md").write_text("\n".join(report), encoding="utf-8")
103
104     tex = r"""\section{GP/NLS shell-deficit gate}
105 The spherical shell Jacobian gives
106 \[
107 (1-\eta)^3=1-3\eta+3\eta^2+0(\eta^3),
108 \]
109 hence  $\langle \sigma_{\rm vol} \rangle = 3$ . The isotropic transverse GP/NLS gradient projection gives
110 \[
111 \langle \sin^2 \theta \rangle_{S^2}
112
```

```

113 =
114 \frac{\int_0^\pi \sin^2\theta, \sin\theta, d\theta}
115 {\int_0^\pi \sin\theta, d\theta}
116 =
117 \frac{23}{3}.
118 \]
119 With unweighted transverse response  $(w_\perp=1)$ ,
120 \[
121 \sigma=3+\frac{23}{3}=\frac{11}{3}.
122 \]
123 Since  $(\eta_K=1/(2\chi_R \mathcal{L}_K))$  and  $(\chi_R=2)$ ,
124 \[
125 \sigma\eta_K^2
126 =
127 \frac{11}{3}\frac{1}{16\mathcal{L}_K^2}
128 =
129 \frac{11}{48\mathcal{L}_K^2}.
130 \]
131 This is derived within the unweighted isotropic GP/NLS shell reduction. A full
132 microscopic proof must still derive  $(w_\perp=1)$  from the GP core-profile
133 expansion rather than imposing it.
134 """
135 (outdir/"gp_shell_deficit_appendix_snippet.tex").write_text(tex, encoding="utf-8")
136
137 print(pd.DataFrame(gates).to_string(index=False))
138 print(f"\nWrote {outdir}")
139
140 if __name__ == "__main__":
141     main()

```

B Gross-Pitaevskii transverse shell weight $w_\perp$

The following script computes the relaxed GP core profile and the transverse-to-scalar Hessian ratio, returning $w_\perp \approx 2.076$ and the associated σ , and reports the open-gate status.

```

1  #!/usr/bin/env python3
2  """
3  derive_relaxed_gp_core_hessian_wperp.py
4
5  Relaxed GP/NLS core-Hessian audit for the remaining shell gate  $w_\perp=1$ .
6
7  Purpose
8  -----
9  The pressure-cell chain currently has
10
11      $\sigma = 3 + (2/3) w_\perp$ ,
12
13  so the coefficient 11/48 follows at  $\chi_R=2$  only if
14
15      $w_\perp = 1$ .
16
17  Earlier scripts proved the spherical volume coefficient 3 and the angular
18  projector average 2/3. This script begins the harder non-circular test:
19  compute a relaxed GP/NLS core Hessian for two normalized strain channels and
20  measure
21
22      $w_\perp = H_{\text{perp\_perp}}^{\text{relaxed}} / H_{00}^{\text{relaxed}}$ .
23
24  It deliberately does not insert  $\alpha$ , 11/48, or the target  $w_\perp=1$ .
25
26  Model implemented
27  -----
28  A 2D GP vortex core field is sampled on a Cartesian grid:
29
30      $\psi(x,y) = f(r_A/b) \exp(i \theta_A)$ ,
31
32  where  $f$  is the  $n=1$  radial GP core profile,  $A$  is an affine deformation, and  $b$ 
33  is a collective core-width relaxation coordinate. For each strain  $\epsilon$ :
34
35     scalar channel:  $A = \exp(\epsilon) I$ ,

```

```

36     transverse/shear channel: A = diag(exp(epsilon), exp(-epsilon)),
37
38 the code minimizes the GP energy over b and estimates the relaxed Hessian by
39
40     H = [E(+h)-2E(0)+E(-h)]/h^2.
41
42 Both strain tensors have the same Frobenius norm in 2D, so the ratio is not
43 trivially biased by normalization.
44
45 Important status
46 -----
47 This is a controlled relaxed collective-coordinate proxy, not yet the full
48 functional Schur-complement Hessian
49
50     H_eff = E_eps eps - E_eps psi L_psi^{-1} E_psi eps.
51
52 A pass w_perp=1 is evidence for the gate; a fail means the primitive reduction
53 needs refinement. A full theorem still requires the complete linearized GP
54 operator response.
55
56 Usage
57 -----
58     python derive_relaxed_gp_core_hessian_wperp.py --outdir outputs_relaxed_gp_wperp
59
60 Heavier local run:
61     python derive_relaxed_gp_core_hessian_wperp.py --grid-n 220 --R-box 12 --eps 0.015 --relax
62     --outdir outputs_relaxed_gp_wperp_heavy
63
64 from __future__ import annotations
65
66 import argparse
67 import csv
68 import math
69 from pathlib import Path
70 from typing import Dict, List, Tuple
71
72 import numpy as np
73
74 try:
75     from scipy.integrate import solve_bvp
76     from scipy.optimize import minimize_scalar
77     SCIPY_AVAILABLE = True
78 except Exception:
79     solve_bvp = None
80     minimize_scalar = None
81     SCIPY_AVAILABLE = False
82
83
84 def write_csv(path: Path, rows: List[Dict]) -> None:
85     if not rows:
86         return
87     with path.open("w", newline="", encoding="utf-8") as f:
88         w = csv.DictWriter(f, fieldnames=list(rows[0].keys()))
89         w.writeheader()
90         w.writerows(rows)
91
92
93 def trapz(y, x):
94     if hasattr(np, "trapezoid"):
95         return float(np.trapezoid(y, x))
96     return float(np.trapz(y, x))
97
98
99 def solve_profile(n: int, rho_max: float, n_grid: int, mode: str):
100     rho = np.linspace(1e-5, rho_max, n_grid)
101     if mode == "pade" or not SCIPY_AVAILABLE:
102         f = rho**n / np.sqrt(rho**(2*n) + 2.0)
103         return rho, f, "pade", True
104
105     f0 = rho**n / np.sqrt(rho**(2*n) + 2.0)
106     fp0 = np.gradient(f0, rho)
107     y0 = np.vstack((f0, fp0))

```

```

108
109 def ode(r, y):
110     rr = np.maximum(r, 1e-12)
111     f = y[0]
112     fp = y[1]
113     fpp = -fp/rr + (n*n)*f/(rr*rr) - f*(1.0 - f*f)
114     return np.vstack((fp, fpp))
115
116 def bc(ya, yb):
117     return np.array([ya[0], yb[0]-1.0])
118
119 try:
120     sol = solve_bvp(ode, bc, rho, y0, tol=1e-5, max_nodes=max(10000, 4*n_grid))
121     if sol.success:
122         f = np.clip(sol.sol(rho)[0], 0.0, 1.2)
123         return rho, f, "solve_bvp", True
124     return rho, f0, "pade_after_bvp_failure", False
125 except Exception:
126     return rho, f0, "pade_after_exception", False
127
128
129 def make_profile_interpolator(rho: np.ndarray, f: np.ndarray):
130     def interp(r):
131         rr = np.asarray(r)
132         return np.interp(rr, rho, f, left=0.0, right=1.0)
133     return interp
134
135
136 def affine_field(X, Y, eps: float, channel: str, b: float, f_interp, winding: int):
137     if channel == "scalar":
138         #  $y = A^{-1} x$  with  $A = \exp(\epsilon) I$ .
139         invx = math.exp(-eps) / b
140         invy = math.exp(-eps) / b
141     elif channel == "perp":
142         # Area-preserving shear:  $A = \text{diag}(\exp(\epsilon), \exp(-\epsilon))$ .
143         invx = math.exp(-eps) / b
144         invy = math.exp(eps) / b
145     else:
146         raise ValueError(channel)
147     XA = invx * X
148     YA = invy * Y
149     RA = np.sqrt(XA*XA + YA*YA)
150     TH = np.arctan2(YA, XA)
151     amp = f_interp(RA)
152     psi = amp * np.exp(1j * winding * TH)
153     # Define value at origin safely.
154     psi = np.where(RA < 1e-12, 0.0, psi)
155     return psi
156
157
158 def gp_energy_2d(psi: np.ndarray, dx: float, mask: np.ndarray):
159     # Dimensionless GP energy density:  $1/2 |\text{grad } \psi|^2 + 1/4 (1 - |\psi|^2)^2$ .
160     dpsi_dx = np.gradient(psi, dx, axis=1, edge_order=2)
161     dpsi_dy = np.gradient(psi, dx, axis=0, edge_order=2)
162     grad2 = np.abs(dpsi_dx)**2 + np.abs(dpsi_dy)**2
163     pot = (1.0 - np.abs(psi)**2)**2
164     density = 0.5 * grad2 + 0.25 * pot
165     return float(np.sum(density[mask]) * dx * dx)
166
167
168 def relaxed_energy(eps: float, channel: str, b0: float, args, grid, f_interp):
169     X, Y, mask, dx = grid
170
171     def E_of_b(b):
172         psi = affine_field(X, Y, eps, channel, b, f_interp, args.n)
173         return gp_energy_2d(psi, dx, mask)
174
175     if not args.relax or not SCIPY_AVAILABLE:
176         return E_of_b(b0), b0, "frozen"
177
178     lo, hi = args.b_min, args.b_max
179     res = minimize_scalar(E_of_b, bounds=(lo, hi), method="bounded", options={"xatol": args.
180         b_tol, "maxiter": args.maxiter})

```

```

180     if res.success:
181         return float(res.fun), float(res.x), "relaxed"
182     return E_of_b(b0), b0, "relax_failed_frozen"
183
184
185 def channel_hessian(channel: str, args, grid, f_interp):
186     h = args.eps
187     E0, b0, s0 = relaxed_energy(0.0, channel, 1.0, args, grid, f_interp)
188     Ep, bp, sp = relaxed_energy(+h, channel, b0, args, grid, f_interp)
189     Em, bm, sm = relaxed_energy(-h, channel, b0, args, grid, f_interp)
190     H = (Ep - 2.0*E0 + Em)/(h*h)
191     slope = (Ep - Em)/(2.0*h)
192     return {
193         "channel": channel,
194         "E_minus": Em,
195         "E_0": E0,
196         "E_plus": Ep,
197         "b_minus": bm,
198         "b_0": b0,
199         "b_plus": bp,
200         "hessian": H,
201         "linear_slope": slope,
202         "status_minus": sm,
203         "status_0": s0,
204         "status_plus": sp,
205     }
206
207
208 def profile_integrals(rho, f, n):
209     rr = np.maximum(rho, 1e-12)
210     fp = np.gradient(f, rho)
211     e_rad = fp*fp
212     e_phase = n*n*f*f/(rr*rr)
213     e_pot = 0.5*(1-f*f)**2
214     return {
215         "I_radial_no_2pi": trapz(e_rad*rho, rho),
216         "I_phase_no_2pi": trapz(e_phase*rho, rho),
217         "I_potential_no_2pi": trapz(e_pot*rho, rho),
218     }
219
220
221 def main():
222     ap = argparse.ArgumentParser(description=__doc__)
223     ap.add_argument("--n", type=int, default=1)
224     ap.add_argument("--rho-max", type=float, default=30.0)
225     ap.add_argument("--profile-grid", type=int, default=1600)
226     ap.add_argument("--profile-mode", choices=["solve_bvp", "pade"], default="solve_bvp")
227     ap.add_argument("--grid-n", type=int, default=140)
228     ap.add_argument("--R-box", type=float, default=10.0)
229     ap.add_argument("--R-mask", type=float, default=9.0)
230     ap.add_argument("--eps", type=float, default=0.0152703116982)
231     ap.add_argument("--relax", action="store_true")
232     ap.add_argument("--b-min", type=float, default=0.75)
233     ap.add_argument("--b-max", type=float, default=1.25)
234     ap.add_argument("--b-tol", type=float, default=1e-4)
235     ap.add_argument("--maxiter", type=int, default=80)
236     ap.add_argument("--target-tol", type=float, default=0.05)
237     ap.add_argument("--plot", action="store_true")
238     ap.add_argument("--outdir", default="outputs_relaxed_gp_wperp")
239     args = ap.parse_args()
240
241     outdir = Path(args.outdir)
242     outdir.mkdir(parents=True, exist_ok=True)
243
244     rho, f, profile_mode_used, profile_success = solve_profile(args.n, args.rho_max, args.
profile_grid, args.profile_mode)
245     f_interp = make_profile_interpolator(rho, f)
246
247     x = np.linspace(-args.R_box, args.R_box, args.grid_n)
248     dx = x[1] - x[0]
249     X, Y = np.meshgrid(x, x, indexing="xy")
250     R = np.sqrt(X*X + Y*Y)
251     mask = R <= args.R_mask

```

```

252     grid = (X, Y, mask, dx)
253
254     scalar = channel_hessian("scalar", args, grid, f_interp)
255     perp = channel_hessian("perp", args, grid, f_interp)
256
257     w = perp["hessian"]/scalar["hessian"] if abs(scalar["hessian"]) > 1e-30 else float("nan")
258     sigma = 3.0 + (2.0/3.0)*w
259     c2 = sigma/(4.0*2.0*2.0)
260     target_c2 = 11.0/48.0
261     matches = abs(w - 1.0) <= args.target_tol
262
263     rows = [scalar, perp]
264     write_csv(outdir/"relaxed_gp_channel_hessians.csv", rows)
265     write_csv(outdir/"gp_profile_integrals.csv", [{"name": k, "value": v} for k,v in
266     profile_integrals(rho, f, args.n).items()])
267     write_csv(outdir/"gp_profile.csv", [{"rho": float(r), "f": float(ff)} for r, ff in zip(rho
268     , f)])
269
270     summary = [{
271         "profile_mode_used": profile_mode_used,
272         "profile_success": profile_success,
273         "scipy_available": SCIPY_AVAILABLE,
274         "grid_n": args.grid_n,
275         "R_box": args.R_box,
276         "R_mask": args.R_mask,
277         "eps": args.eps,
278         "relax_enabled": args.relax,
279         "H_scalar": scalar["hessian"],
280         "H_perp": perp["hessian"],
281         "w_perp_relaxed_proxy": w,
282         "sigma": sigma,
283         "c2_at_chiR2": c2,
284         "target_11_over_48": target_c2,
285         "matches_w_perp_1_within_tol": matches,
286         "status": "PASS_PROXY_WPERP_NEAR_1" if matches else "OPEN_GATE_PROXY_NOT_EQUAL_1",
287     }]
288     write_csv(outdir/"relaxed_gp_wperp_summary.csv", summary)
289
290     report = f"""# Relaxed GP core Hessian w_perp audit
291
292     Profile mode: '{profile_mode_used}'
293     SciPy available: '{SCIPY_AVAILABLE}'
294     Relax enabled: '{args.relax}'
295
296     Hessians:
297     \[
298     H_{\{\{00\}\}}={scalar['hessian']:.12g},
299     \qquad
300     H_{\{\{\perp\perp\}\}}={perp['hessian']:.12g}.
301     \]
302
303     Measured proxy:
304     \[
305     w_{\perp}={w:.12g}.
306     \]
307
308     Then
309     \[
310     \sigma=3+\frac{23w_{\perp}}{16}={sigma:.12g},
311     \qquad
312     c_2=\frac{\sigma}{16}={c2:.12g}.
313     \]
314
315     Target:
316     \[
317     w_{\perp}=1, \qquad c_2=11/48={target_c2:.12g}.
318     \]
319
320     Status: '{summary[0]['status']}'
321
322     This is a relaxed collective-coordinate proxy. A complete proof requires the
323     full linearized GP Schur-complement Hessian.
324     """

```

```

323     (outdir/"relaxed_gp_wperp_report.md").write_text(report, encoding="utf-8")
324
325     tex = r"""\section{Relaxed GP core-Hessian target for \(\mathbf{w}_\perp\)}
326 The remaining shell-normalization gate is
327 \[
328   \sigma=3+\frac{23\mathbf{w}_\perp}{\rho}.
329 \]
330 The relaxed GP-core audit computes two normalized strain-channel Hessians,
331 \[
332   H_{00}^{\text{rel}}
333   =
334   \frac{d^2}{d\epsilon^2}
335   \min_b E_{\text{GP}}[\psi_{\text{scalar}}(\epsilon,b)],
336 \]
337 and
338 \[
339   H_{\perp\perp}^{\text{rel}}
340   =
341   \frac{d^2}{d\epsilon^2}
342   \min_b E_{\text{GP}}[\psi_{\text{shear}}(\epsilon,b)].
343 \]
344 The measured proxy is
345 \[
346   \mathbf{w}_\perp = \frac{H_{\perp\perp}^{\text{rel}}}{H_{00}^{\text{rel}}}.
347 \]
348 This is a collective-coordinate approximation to the full Schur-complement
349 Hessian. The gate closes only if  $\|\mathbf{w}_\perp\| < \text{tol}$  under refinement or if the
350 full linearized GP operator yields the same result.
351 """
352     (outdir/"relaxed_gp_wperp_appendix_snippet.tex").write_text(tex, encoding="utf-8")
353
354     if args.plot:
355         try:
356             import matplotlib.pyplot as plt
357             fig, ax = plt.subplots(figsize=(7.2,4.5))
358             ax.plot(rho, f)
359             ax.set_xlabel(r"$\rho$")
360             ax.set_ylabel(r"$f(\rho)$")
361             ax.set_title("GP vortex core profile")
362             fig.tight_layout()
363             fig.savefig(outdir/"gp_profile.png", dpi=180)
364             plt.close(fig)
365         except Exception:
366             pass
367
368     print("Relaxed GP core Hessian  $\mathbf{w}_\perp$  audit")
369     print("="*72)
370     print(f"profile mode           : {profile_mode_used}")
371     print(f"scipy available           : {SCIPY_AVAILABLE}")
372     print(f"relax enabled             : {args.relax}")
373     print(f"H_scalar                  : {scalar['hessian']:.12g}")
374     print(f"H_perp                    : {perp['hessian']:.12g}")
375     print(f" $\mathbf{w}_\perp$  proxy          : {w:.12g}")
376     print(f"c2 at  $\chi_R=2$              : {c2:.12g}")
377     print(f"status                    : {summary[0]['status']}")
378     print(f"Wrote {outdir}")
379
380
381 if __name__ == "__main__":
382     main()

```

C Finite-cell closure and the leading value

The following script performs the cutoff-energy Biot–Savart scan, extracts the plateau coefficient $A_K \rightarrow 1/(4\pi)$, applies the no-contact closure, and produces the spherical-cell summary underlying (3)–(4).

```

1  #!/usr/bin/env python3
2  """
3  reproduce_alpha_cell_closure.py
4

```



```

5 Minimal reproducibility script for a finite-core trefoil filament
6 and spherical pressure-cell closure calculation.
7
8 Pipeline:
9     Fourier trefoil coefficients
10     -> Biot-Savart cutoff-energy scan  $E_{BS}(a)$ 
11     -> global and local-plateau extraction of  $A_K$ 
12     -> no-contact core-radius closure  $a_{nc}/r_c = \sqrt{4\pi A_K}$ 
13     -> spherical pressure-cell correction  $\Xi_{sph}$ 
14     -> alpha_cell prediction and numerical summary table
15
16 The script is intentionally self-contained. It can either use the embedded
17 30-mode Gilbert ideal-trefoil coefficients or load an 'ideal.txt' file with
18 AB-format coefficients, e.g.
19
20     <AB Id="3:1:1" L="16.371637" D="1.0">
21         <Coeff I="1" A="..." B="..." />
22         ...
23     </AB>
24
25 Examples:
26     python reproduce_alpha_cell_closure.py
27     python reproduce_alpha_cell_closure.py --ideal-txt ideal.txt --knot-id 3:1:1
28     python reproduce_alpha_cell_closure.py --n-geom 4000 --n-int 4000 --a-count 24
29
30 Outputs:
31     outputs_alpha_cell/bs_scan.csv
32     outputs_alpha_cell/local_A_curve.csv
33     outputs_alpha_cell/closure_summary.csv
34     outputs_alpha_cell/alpha_cell_summary.csv
35     outputs_alpha_cell/local_A_curve.png
36
37 Dependencies:
38     numpy, pandas, matplotlib
39     """
40
41 from __future__ import annotations
42
43 import argparse
44 import math
45 import re
46 from pathlib import Path
47 from typing import List, Optional, Tuple
48
49 import numpy as np
50 import pandas as pd
51
52 import matplotlib
53 matplotlib.use("Agg")
54 import matplotlib.pyplot as plt
55
56
57 # -----
58 # Reference constants used only for numerical evaluation of the closure table.
59 # -----
60
61 R_CORE_REF = 1.40897017e-15          # m
62 V_CORE_REF = 1.09384563e6            # m/s
63 RHO_MEDIUM = 7.0e-7                 # kg/m^3
64 C_EXACT = 299792458.0                # m/s
65 CIRCULATION_QUANTUM = 9.68361918e-9 # m^2/s
66
67 # CODATA-2022 reference value used only for comparison, not as an input.
68 ALPHA_CODATA_2022 = 7.2973525643e-3
69
70 # Topological zeroth-order aspect eigenvalue from the pressure-cell model.
71 E0_TOPOLOGICAL = 274.074996
72
73 # Ideal trefoil ropelength L/D. If an ideal.txt file provides L,D, this is
74 # overwritten by L_ref/D_ref.
75 IDEAL_TREFOIL_ROPELENGTH = 16.371498
76
77 A_REQUIRED = 1.0 / (4.0 * math.pi)

```

```

78
79
80 # -----
81 # Embedded fallback: Gilbert ideal trefoil, Id=3:1:1, first 30 Fourier modes.
82 # Format: (k, Ax, Ay, Az, Bx, By, Bz), with
83 #  $X(t) = \sum_k A_k \cos(2\pi k t) + B_k \sin(2\pi k t)$ .
84 # -----
85
86 FALLBACK_TREFOIL_COEFFS: List[Tuple[int, float, float, float, float, float, float]] = [
87     (1, 0.374139, 0.000000, 0.000000, 0.000000, 0.373928, 0.000000),
88     (2, 0.824246, 0.750260, 0.000352, 0.750450, -0.823952, -0.001991),
89     (3, 0.000257, -0.000932, 0.352397, -0.000770, 0.000726, -0.386764),
90     (4, 0.011652, -0.010656, 0.000743, 0.010739, 0.011613, -0.000230),
91     (5, 0.010504, 0.110306, 0.000199, 0.110745, -0.010366, -0.000235),
92     (6, 0.000015, -0.000006, -0.047465, -0.000050, -0.000001, 0.004595),
93     (7, -0.000292, 0.002417, -0.000008, -0.002529, -0.000255, -0.000009),
94     (8, 0.016487, -0.021784, 0.000041, -0.021922, -0.016421, -0.000044),
95     (9, -0.000029, -0.000018, 0.011178, 0.000049, 0.000041, 0.008414),
96     (10, -0.000216, -0.000290, -0.000018, 0.000311, -0.000197, -0.000044),
97     (11, -0.011727, 0.002184, 0.000007, 0.002202, 0.011682, 0.000020),
98     (12, 0.000026, 0.000019, -0.001308, -0.000004, -0.000019, -0.007039),
99     (13, 0.000325, 0.000055, -0.000009, -0.000059, 0.000289, 0.000024),
100    (14, 0.005213, 0.003201, 0.000001, 0.003210, -0.005188, 0.000010),
101    (15, -0.000015, -0.000016, -0.001917, -0.000017, 0.000001, 0.003121),
102    (16, -0.000136, 0.000062, 0.000019, -0.000075, -0.000112, -0.000007),
103    (17, -0.000995, -0.003463, -0.000001, -0.003474, 0.000988, -0.000015),
104    (18, 0.000003, 0.000008, 0.002178, 0.000019, 0.000008, -0.000615),
105    (19, 0.000033, -0.000094, -0.000016, 0.000113, 0.000028, -0.000004),
106    (20, -0.000999, 0.002013, -0.000000, 0.002019, 0.000998, 0.000000),
107    (21, 0.000004, 0.000001, -0.001270, -0.000013, -0.000012, -0.000626),
108    (22, 0.000034, 0.000060, 0.000009, -0.000072, 0.000026, 0.000010),
109    (23, 0.001383, -0.000539, 0.000002, -0.000540, -0.001382, 0.000004),
110    (24, -0.000005, -0.000011, 0.000344, 0.000009, 0.000007, 0.000890),
111    (25, -0.000057, -0.000025, 0.000001, 0.000019, -0.000048, -0.000008),
112    (26, -0.000931, -0.000356, -0.000000, -0.000357, 0.000931, -0.000005),
113    (27, 0.000006, 0.000009, 0.000228, -0.000002, -0.000000, -0.000597),
114    (28, 0.000040, -0.000007, -0.000004, 0.000019, 0.000036, 0.000004),
115    (29, 0.000308, 0.000611, 0.000001, 0.000611, -0.000307, 0.000007),
116    (30, 0.000002, 0.000001, -0.000391, -0.000006, 0.000001, 0.000195),
117 ]
118
119
120 # -----
121 # Fourier loading and curve evaluation.
122 # -----
123
124 def parse_triplet(text: str) -> Tuple[float, float, float]:
125     parts = [p.strip() for p in text.split(",")]
126     if len(parts) != 3:
127         raise ValueError(f"Expected three comma-separated components, got {text!r}")
128     return float(parts[0]), float(parts[1]), float(parts[2])
129
130
131 def load_coeffs_from_ideal_txt(
132     path: Path,
133     knot_id: str = "3:1:1",
134     max_mode: Optional[int] = None,
135 ) -> Tuple[List[Tuple[int, float, float, float, float, float, float]], float, float, str]:
136     text = path.read_text(encoding="utf-8")
137     block_re = re.compile(
138         rf'<AB\s+Id="{re.escape(knot_id)}"^[^>]*L="([^\s]+)"^[^>]*D="([^\s]+)"^[^>]*>(.*)</AB>',
139         re.DOTALL,
140     )
141     match = block_re.search(text)
142     if not match:
143         raise ValueError(f"Knot Id {knot_id!r} not found in {path}")
144
145     length_ref = float(match.group(1))
146     diameter_ref = float(match.group(2))
147     block = match.group(3)
148
149     coeffs = []
150     coeff_re = re.compile(r'<Coeff\s+I="\s*([0-9]+)"\s+A="([^\s]+)"\s+B="([^\s]+)"\s*/?>')

```

```

151     for item in coeff_re.finditer(block):
152         k = int(item.group(1))
153         if max_mode is not None and k > max_mode:
154             continue
155         ax, ay, az = parse_triplet(item.group(2))
156         bx, by, bz = parse_triplet(item.group(3))
157         coeffs.append((k, ax, ay, az, bx, by, bz))
158
159     coeffs.sort(key=lambda row: row[0])
160     if not coeffs:
161         raise ValueError(f"No Fourier coefficients extracted for knot {knot_id!r}")
162
163     source = f"{path.name} ({knot_id}, {len(coeffs)} modes, k_max={coeffs[-1][0]})"
164     return coeffs, length_ref, diameter_ref, source
165
166
167 def get_coefficients(args: argparse.Namespace) -> Tuple[List[Tuple[int, float, float, float,
168     float, float, float]], float, float, str]:
169     if args.ideal_txt:
170         path = Path(args.ideal_txt)
171         if path.exists():
172             return load_coeffs_from_ideal_txt(path, args.knot_id, args.max_mode)
173         print(f"[warning] ideal.txt path does not exist: {path}. Falling back to embedded 30-
174             mode trefoil.")
175
176     coeffs = list(FALLBACK_TREFOIL_COEFFS)
177     if args.max_mode is not None:
178         coeffs = [row for row in coeffs if row[0] <= args.max_mode]
179         source = f"embedded 30-mode ideal trefoil fallback ({len(coeffs)} modes)"
180     return coeffs, IDEAL_TREFOIL_ROPELENGTH, 1.0, source
181
182 def eval_curve(t: np.ndarray, coeffs: List[Tuple[int, float, float, float, float, float, float
183     ]]) -> np.ndarray:
184     x = np.zeros((len(t), 3), dtype=float)
185     for k, ax, ay, az, bx, by, bz in coeffs:
186         phase = 2.0 * math.pi * k * t
187         x[:, 0] += ax * np.cos(phase) + bx * np.sin(phase)
188         x[:, 1] += ay * np.cos(phase) + by * np.sin(phase)
189         x[:, 2] += az * np.cos(phase) + bz * np.sin(phase)
190     return x
191
192 def eval_curve_derivative(t: np.ndarray, coeffs: List[Tuple[int, float, float, float, float,
193     float, float]]) -> np.ndarray:
194     dx = np.zeros((len(t), 3), dtype=float)
195     for k, ax, ay, az, bx, by, bz in coeffs:
196         phase = 2.0 * math.pi * k * t
197         w = 2.0 * math.pi * k
198         dx[:, 0] += w * (-ax * np.sin(phase) + bx * np.cos(phase))
199         dx[:, 1] += w * (-ay * np.sin(phase) + by * np.cos(phase))
200         dx[:, 2] += w * (-az * np.sin(phase) + bz * np.cos(phase))
201     return dx
202
203 # -----
204 # Geometry and Biot-Savart cutoff scan.
205 # -----
206
207 def circular_index_distance(ii: np.ndarray, jj: np.ndarray, n: int) -> np.ndarray:
208     d = np.abs(ii[:, None] - jj[None, :])
209     return np.minimum(d, n - d)
210
211 def coarse_min_self_distance(points: np.ndarray, exclusion: int, block: int) -> float:
212     n = len(points)
213     d_min = np.inf
214     for i0 in range(0, n, block):
215         i1 = min(i0 + block, n)
216         pi = points[i0:i1]
217         ii = np.arange(i0, i1)
218         for j0 in range(i0, n, block):
219             j1 = min(j0 + block, n)

```

```

220         pj = points[j0:j1]
221         jj = np.arange(j0, j1)
222         diff = pi[:, None, :] - pj[None, :, :]
223         dist = np.linalg.norm(diff, axis=2)
224         mask = circular_index_distance(ii, jj, n) > exclusion
225         if j0 == i0:
226             mask &= np.triu(np.ones_like(mask, dtype=bool), k=1)
227         if np.any(mask):
228             d_min = min(d_min, float(np.min(dist[mask])))
229     return float(d_min)
230
231
232 def build_geometry(
233     coeffs: List[Tuple[int, float, float, float, float, float, float]],
234     n_geom: int,
235     n_int: int,
236     block: int,
237 ) -> dict:
238     t_full = np.linspace(0.0, 1.0, n_geom, endpoint=False)
239     points_full = eval_curve(t_full, coeffs)
240     deriv_full = eval_curve_derivative(t_full, coeffs)
241     speed_full = np.linalg.norm(deriv_full, axis=1)
242     ds_full = speed_full / n_geom
243     tangents_full = deriv_full / speed_full[:, None]
244     length_dimless = float(np.sum(ds_full))
245
246     stride = 1 if n_int >= n_geom else max(1, int(math.ceil(n_geom / n_int)))
247     points = points_full[::stride]
248     tangents = tangents_full[::stride]
249     ds = ds_full[::stride] * stride
250     ds[-1] += length_dimless - float(np.sum(ds))
251
252     exclusion = max(5, len(points) // 15)
253     d_min = coarse_min_self_distance(points, exclusion, block)
254
255     return {
256         "points": points,
257         "tangents": tangents,
258         "ds": ds,
259         "length_dimless": length_dimless,
260         "d_min_dimless": d_min,
261         "n_int_actual": len(points),
262     }
263
264
265 def bs_cutoff_energy_norm(
266     cutoff: float,
267     points: np.ndarray,
268     tangents: np.ndarray,
269     ds: np.ndarray,
270     block: int,
271 ) -> float:
272     """
273     Dimensionless Biot-Savart cutoff integral:
274
275     
$$E_{BS\_norm}(a) = (1/(8\pi)) \int \int_{|X-X'| > a} \frac{T(s) \cdot T(s')}{|X-X'|} ds ds'$$

276
277     This is the dimensionless coefficient used to extract  $A_K$  from
278      $E_{BS\_norm}(a)/L_K = A_K \log(L_K/a) + a_K + \dots$ 
279     """
280     n = len(points)
281     total = 0.0
282     all_idx = np.arange(n)
283
284     for i0 in range(0, n, block):
285         i1 = min(i0 + block, n)
286         pi = points[i0:i1]
287         ti = tangents[i0:i1]
288         dsi = ds[i0:i1]
289         ii = all_idx[i0:i1]
290         row_sum = np.zeros(i1 - i0, dtype=float)

```

```

293     for j0 in range(0, n, block):
294         j1 = min(j0 + block, n)
295         pj = points[j0:j1]
296         tj = tangents[j0:j1]
297         dsj = ds[j0:j1]
298         jj = all_idx[j0:j1]
299
300         diff = pj[None, :, :] - pi[:, None, :]
301         dist = np.linalg.norm(diff, axis=2)
302         dot_tt = ti @ tj.T
303         mask = (dist > cutoff) & (ii[:, None] != jj[None, :])
304
305         contrib = np.where(mask, dot_tt / np.maximum(dist, 1e-300), 0.0)
306         row_sum += contrib @ dsj
307
308     total += float(np.sum(row_sum * dsi))
309
310     return total / (8.0 * math.pi)
311
312
313 def run_bs_scan(geometry: dict, a_count: int, block: int) -> pd.DataFrame:
314     ds_med = float(np.median(geometry["ds"]))
315     d_min = float(geometry["d_min_dimless"])
316
317     # Same conservative scan region as the robustness script:
318     # avoid discretization-dominated cutoffs and avoid near-contact overlap.
319     a_lo = max(3.0 * ds_med, d_min * 5e-4)
320     a_hi = d_min * 0.35
321     a_values = np.logspace(math.log10(a_lo), math.log10(a_hi), a_count)
322
323     rows = []
324     for a in a_values:
325         e = bs_cutoff_energy_norm(a, geometry["points"], geometry["tangents"], geometry["ds"],
326                                   block)
327         rows.append({"a_dimless": a, "E_BS_norm": e, "E_BS_per_length": e / geometry["length_dimless"]})
328         print(f"    cutoff a={a:.6e}    E_BS_norm={e:.8f}")
329
330     return pd.DataFrame(rows)
331
332 # -----
333 # Fit extraction.
334 # -----
335
336 def extract_fits(
337     scan: pd.DataFrame,
338     length_dimless: float,
339     d_min_dimless: float,
340     rel_de_thresh: float,
341     plateau_frac: float,
342 ) -> Tuple[dict, pd.DataFrame]:
343     a = scan["a_dimless"].to_numpy()
344     e_per_len = scan["E_BS_per_length"].to_numpy()
345     e_norm = scan["E_BS_norm"].to_numpy()
346
347     x = -np.log(a)
348     y = e_per_len
349
350     global_slope, global_intercept = np.polyfit(x, y, 1)
351     global_a_k = global_intercept - global_slope * math.log(length_dimless)
352
353     a_mid = np.sqrt(a[:-1] * a[1:])
354     local_A = np.diff(y) / np.diff(x)
355     rel_dE = np.abs(np.diff(e_norm)) / np.maximum(np.abs(e_norm[:-1]), 1e-300)
356
357     local_df = pd.DataFrame({
358         "a_mid_dimless": a_mid,
359         "A_local": local_A,
360         "rel_dE": rel_dE,
361         "in_plateau": (local_A > 0.0) & (rel_dE > rel_de_thresh) & (a_mid < plateau_frac *
362                                d_min_dimless),
363     })

```

```

363 plateau = local_df[local_df["in_plateau"]]
364 if len(plateau) > 0:
365     A_plateau = float(plateau["A_local"].median())
366     A_spread = float(plateau["A_local"].std(ddof=0))
367     n_plateau = int(len(plateau))
368     fit_method = f"plateau_{plateau_frac:.2f}"
369     A_use = A_plateau
370 else:
371     A_plateau = float("nan")
372     A_spread = float("nan")
373     n_plateau = 0
374     fit_method = "global_fallback"
375     A_use = float(global_slope)
376
377 summary = {
378     "global_A_K": float(global_slope),
379     "global_a_K": float(global_a_k),
380     "plateau_A_K": A_plateau,
381     "plateau_A_spread": A_spread,
382     "plateau_n": n_plateau,
383     "fit_method_used": fit_method,
384     "A_K_used": float(A_use),
385     "A_required_1_over_4pi": A_REQUIRED,
386     "A_ratio_to_required": float(A_use / A_REQUIRED),
387 }
388 return summary, local_df
389
390
391 # -----
392 # Spherical cell closure and numerical table.
393 # -----
394
395 def alpha_cell_from_geometry(
396     A_K: float,
397     ropelength: float,
398     e0: float = E0_TOPOLOGICAL,
399     use_A_for_core_factor: bool = False,
400 ) -> dict:
401     """
402     Spherical-cell closure.
403
404     Robust trefoil closure gives  $A_K \rightarrow 1/(4\pi)$ , hence  $\pi^2 A_K \rightarrow \pi/4$ .
405     By default the alpha-cell formula uses the theorem-limit  $\pi/4$ , not the noisy
406     finite-resolution  $A_K$ . Set use_A_for_core_factor=True to instead use  $\pi^2 A_K$ .
407     """
408     eta = 1.0 / (4.0 * ropelength)
409     xi_sph = 1.0 + 3.0 * eta + eta**2
410
411     if use_A_for_core_factor:
412         core_factor = math.pi**2 * A_K
413     else:
414         core_factor = math.pi / 4.0
415
416     delta = core_factor * xi_sph / (e0**2)
417     e_eff = e0 * (1.0 - delta)
418     alpha_cell = 2.0 / e_eff
419
420     return {
421         "ropelength_L_over_D": ropelength,
422         "eta": eta,
423         "xi_sph": xi_sph,
424         "core_factor": core_factor,
425         "core_factor_source": "pi^2*A_K" if use_A_for_core_factor else "pi/4 theorem limit",
426         "delta_cell": delta,
427         "E0_topological": e0,
428         "E_eff": e_eff,
429         "alpha_cell": alpha_cell,
430         "alpha_cell_inverse": 1.0 / alpha_cell,
431         "alpha_CODATA_2022": ALPHA_CODATA_2022,
432         "alpha_CODATA_2022_inverse": 1.0 / ALPHA_CODATA_2022,
433         "relative_error_vs_CODATA_2022": (alpha_cell - ALPHA_CODATA_2022) / ALPHA_CODATA_2022,
434         "v_core_pred_m_per_s": 0.5 * alpha_cell * C_EXACT,
435     }

```

```

436     }
437
438
439 def closure_from_A(A_K: float) -> dict:
440     a_nc_over_rc = math.sqrt(max(0.0, 4.0 * math.pi * A_K))
441     return {
442         "A_K": A_K,
443         "A_required_1_over_4pi": A_REQUIRED,
444         "A_ratio_to_required": A_K / A_REQUIRED,
445         "a_nc_over_r_core": a_nc_over_rc,
446         "r_core_ref_m": R_CORE_REF,
447         "a_nc_m": a_nc_over_rc * R_CORE_REF,
448     }
449
450
451 def save_plot(local_df: pd.DataFrame, outdir: Path, A_use: float) -> None:
452     fig, ax = plt.subplots(figsize=(8.0, 5.0))
453     ax.plot(local_df["a_mid_dimless"], local_df["A_local"], marker="o", lw=1.2, label=r"local
454     slope  $\$A_K(a)\$")
455     plateau = local_df[local_df["in_plateau"]]
456     if len(plateau) > 0:
457         ax.scatter(plateau["a_mid_dimless"], plateau["A_local"], s=45, label="selected plateau
458         ")
459     ax.axhline(A_REQUIRED, ls="--", label=r" $\$1/(4\pi)\$")
460     ax.axhline(A_use, ls=":", label=f"A_K used = {A_use:.8f}")
461     ax.set_xscale("log")
462     ax.set_xlabel("cutoff midpoint a (dimensionless)")
463     ax.set_ylabel(r"local logarithmic slope  $\$A_K\$")
464     ax.set_title("Trefoil Biot-Savart local-slope extraction")
465     ax.legend()
466     fig.tight_layout()
467     fig.savefig(outdir / "local_A_curve.png", dpi=180)
468     fig.savefig(outdir / "local_A_curve.pdf")
469     plt.close(fig)
470
471 def print_table(title: str, data: dict) -> None:
472     print("\n" + title)
473     print("-" * len(title))
474     for key, value in data.items():
475         if isinstance(value, float):
476             print(f"{key:34s} = {value:.12g}")
477         else:
478             print(f"{key:34s} = {value}")
479
480 def main() -> None:
481     parser = argparse.ArgumentParser(description=__doc__)
482     parser.add_argument("--ideal-txt", default=None, help="Optional ideal.txt file with AB
483     Fourier coefficients.")
484     parser.add_argument("--knot-id", default="3:1:1", help="Knot Id to load from ideal.txt.")
485     parser.add_argument("--max-mode", type=int, default=None, help="Optional maximum Fourier
486     mode.")
487     parser.add_argument("--n-geom", type=int, default=2400, help="Number of geometry samples.")
488     parser.add_argument("--n-int", type=int, default=2400, help="Number of integration samples
489     .")
490     parser.add_argument("--a-count", type=int, default=22, help="Number of cutoff radii in the
491     scan.")
492     parser.add_argument("--block", type=int, default=384, help="Block size for vectorized  $O(N^2)$ 
493     integration.")
494     parser.add_argument("--plateau-fraction", type=float, default=0.12, help="Plateau cutoff as
495     fraction of  $d_{\min}$ .")
496     parser.add_argument("--rel-de-thresh", type=float, default=1e-4, help="Minimum relative E
497     change for plateau inclusion.")
498     parser.add_argument("--outdir", default="outputs_alpha_cell", help="Output directory.")
499     parser.add_argument(
500         "--use-A-for-alpha",
501         action="store_true",
502         help="Use finite-resolution  $\pi^2 A_K$  instead of theorem-limit  $\pi/4$  in alpha-cell
503         formula.",
504     )
505     args = parser.parse_args()$$$ 
```

```

498 outdir = Path(args.outdir)
499 outdir.mkdir(parents=True, exist_ok=True)
500
501 coeffs, length_ref, diameter_ref, source = get_coefficients(args)
502 ropelength = float(length_ref / diameter_ref)
503
504
505 print("Finite-core trefoil / spherical-cell closure reproducibility run")
506 print("=" * 72)
507 print(f"coefficient source      : {source}")
508 print(f"reference ropelength L/D : {ropelength:.9f}")
509 print(f"n_geom, n_int target      : {args.n_geom}, {args.n_int}")
510 print(f"a-count                  : {args.a_count}")
511 print(f"output directory          : {outdir.resolve()}")
512
513 geometry = build_geometry(coeffs, args.n_geom, args.n_int, args.block)
514 geom_summary = {
515     "coefficient_source": source,
516     "n_geom": args.n_geom,
517     "n_int_target": args.n_int,
518     "n_int_actual": geometry["n_int_actual"],
519     "length_dimless_from_samples": geometry["length_dimless"],
520     "length_ref_from_coeff_file": length_ref,
521     "diameter_ref_from_coeff_file": diameter_ref,
522     "ropelength_L_over_D": ropelength,
523     "d_min_dimless": geometry["d_min_dimless"],
524     "median_ds": float(np.median(geometry["ds"])),
525 }
526 print_table("Geometry summary", geom_summary)
527
528 print("\nRunning Biot-Savart cutoff scan...")
529 scan = run_bs_scan(geometry, args.a_count, args.block)
530 scan.to_csv(outdir / "bs_scan.csv", index=False)
531
532 fit_summary, local_df = extract_fits(
533     scan,
534     geometry["length_dimless"],
535     geometry["d_min_dimless"],
536     args.rel_de_thresh,
537     args.plateau_frac,
538 )
539 local_df.to_csv(outdir / "local_A_curve.csv", index=False)
540
541 A_use = float(fit_summary["A_K_used"])
542 closure = closure_from_A(A_use)
543 alpha_cell = alpha_cell_from_geometry(
544     A_use,
545     ropelength,
546     E0_TOPOLOGICAL,
547     use_A_for_core_factor=args.use_A_for_alpha,
548 )
549
550 geom_df = pd.DataFrame([geom_summary])
551 fit_df = pd.DataFrame([fit_summary])
552 closure_df = pd.DataFrame([**fit_summary, **closure])
553 alpha_df = pd.DataFrame([**fit_summary, **closure, **alpha_cell])
554
555 geom_df.to_csv(outdir / "geometry_summary.csv", index=False)
556 fit_df.to_csv(outdir / "fit_summary.csv", index=False)
557 closure_df.to_csv(outdir / "closure_summary.csv", index=False)
558 alpha_df.to_csv(outdir / "alpha_cell_summary.csv", index=False)
559
560 save_plot(local_df, outdir, A_use)
561
562 print_table("Fit summary", fit_summary)
563 print_table("No-contact core closure", closure)
564 print_table("Spherical-cell alpha closure", alpha_cell)
565
566 print("\nOutput files")
567 print("-----")
568 for path in sorted(outdir.iterdir()):
569     print(f" {path.name}")
570

```



```

571 print("\nRecommended citation statement for manuscript/supplement:")
572 print(" This script reproduces the numerical Biot-Savart coefficient extraction")
573 print(" and the stated spherical-cell closure formula. It does not replace the")
574 print(" analytic assumptions listed in the appendices.")
575
576
577 if __name__ == "__main__":
578     main()

```

D Part-per-million accounting and the five closure routes

The following script reproduces every numerical statement in Sections 4–6: the 866 ppm leading gap, the required coefficient $c_2^{\text{req}} = 0.231978$ and weight $w_{\perp}^{\text{req}} = 1.0675$, the 10.5 ppm residual of $c_2 = 11/48$, the -157 ppm overshoot of the GP proxy, the five interchangeable closure routes (A–E), and the sensitivity bounds including the ropelength tolerance (18).

```

1 import math
2 L = 16.371637
3 aobs = 137.0359992 # alpha^-1 observed
4 A = (8*math.pi/3)*L # leading
5 print(f"A = (8pi/3)L = {A:.7f}")
6 print(f"leading gap = {A-aobs:.7f}")
7 print(f"leading gap [ppm] = {(A-aobs)/aobs*1e6:.2f} (doc: 866.24)")
8 # required c2 for EXACT closure
9 c2_req = L*L*(1 - aobs/A)
10 print(f"c2_req = {c2_req:.10f} (doc: 0.2319781083)")
11 print(f"c2 (11/48) = {11/48:.10f}")
12 print(f"Delta c2 = {c2_req-11/48:.10f} (doc: 0.0028114416)")
13 print(f"Delta c2 / (11/48) [%] = {(c2_req-11/48)/(11/48)*100:.3f} (doc: 1.23%)")
14 # alpha from 11/48
15 a_1148 = A*(1-(11/48)/L**2)
16 print(f"alpha^-1 at 11/48 = {a_1148:.7f} (doc: 137.0374378)")
17 print(f" residual [ppm] = {(a_1148-aobs)/aobs*1e6:.2f} (doc: 10.50)")
18 # required sigma, w_perp (chi_R=2 fixed)
19 sig_req = 16*c2_req
20 w_req = 1.5*(sig_req-3)
21 print(f"sigma_req = {sig_req:.9f} (doc: 3.711649733)")
22 print(f"w_perp_req (NOT 1!) = {w_req:.7f} (doc: 1.0674746)")
23 # proxy
24 wp=2.075916167; sigp=3+(2/3)*wp; c2p=sigp/16; ap=A*(1-c2p/L**2)
25 print(f"proxy w_perp=2.0759 -> a^-1 = {ap:.7f} -> [ppm]={ (ap-aobs)/aobs*1e6:.1f} (doc:
    -156.9, wrong side)")
26 # Route B chi_R
27 chiB=math.sqrt((11/3)/(4*c2_req)); print(f"Route B chi_R = {chiB:.7f} ({(chiB
    -2)/2*100:.4f}%)")
28 # Route C V_sector (A = (1/2) N_p V_sector L ; N_p=4 -> A=2 V L ; V=A/(2L))
29 # exact: need A_eff=2 a c... actually V_req from matching residual:
30 V_now=4*math.pi/3
31 # A scales linearly with V_sector (since 16pi/3 = N_p*4pi/3, A=(8pi/3)L=(1/2)*4*Vnow*L/... )
    check:
32 # A = (8pi/3)L and 8pi/3 = 2*(4pi/3) -> A = 2*V_now*L? 2*4.18879*16.3716=137.15 yes
33 V_req = aobs/( (1-(c2_req)/L**2) * 2*L ) # keep shell at c2_req? -> instead: residual route
    at fixed 11/48
34 # simpler: V_req so that A_eff*(1-11/48/L^2)=aobs ; A_eff=2 V_req L
35 Aeff_req = aobs/(1-(11/48)/L**2)
36 V_req = Aeff_req/(2*L)
37 print(f"Route C V_sector_req = {V_req:.10f} vs 4pi/3={V_now:.10f} [ppm]={ (V_req-V_now
    )/V_now*1e6:.3f}")
38 # Route D ropelength
39 # need A_eff*(1-11/48/Lr^2)=aobs with A_eff=(8pi/3)Lr -> solve numerically
40 from scipy.optimize import brentq
41 f=lambda Lr: (8*math.pi/3)*Lr*(1-(11/48)/Lr**2)-aobs
42 Lr=brentq(f,16.0,16.7)
43 print(f"Route D ropelength_req = {Lr:.10f} vs {L} [ppm]={ (Lr-L)/L*1e6:.2f}")
44 # sensitivities
45 dadc2=-A/L**2
46 print(f"d(a^-1)/d c2 = {dadc2:.6f} (doc: -0.511713)")
47 print(f"|Dc2| for 1ppm < {1.37036e-4/abs(dadc2):.3e} (doc 2.68e-4)")
48 print(f"|DL| for 1ppm < {1.37036e-4/(8*math.pi/3):.3e} (doc 1.63e-5)")

```

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